



SIMS Foundation 101



Sims Ellison

Sims Ellison (1967-1995), was a prodigious songwriter and member of the band Pariah, one of Austin's most popular hard rock bands in the early 90's. He was loved throughout the Austin music community because of his big heart, laid-back nature and his outgoing personality.

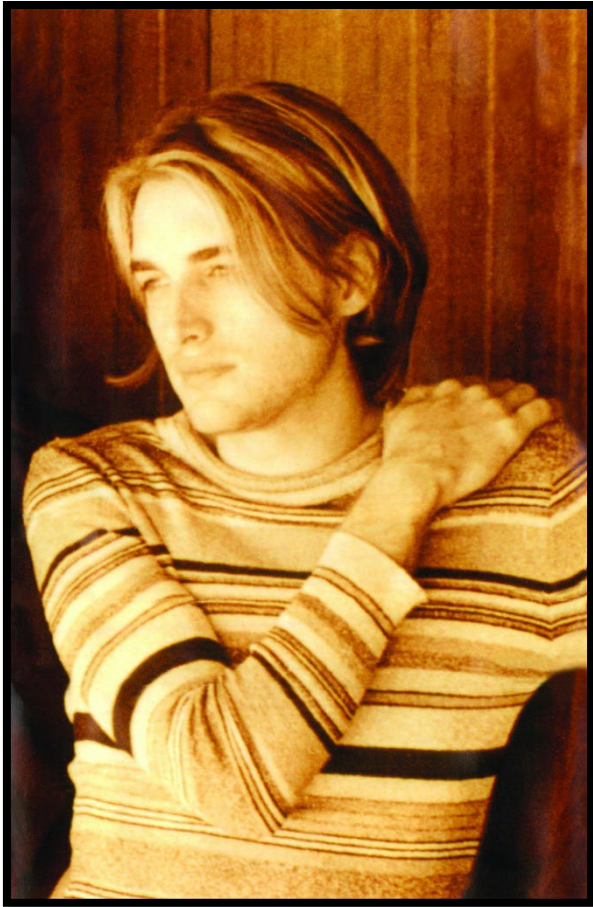
Austin's music community was devastated when Sims lost his battle with depression and died by suicide.



Sims Ellison



The SIMS Foundation



After Sims passed away, the SIMS Foundation was founded by Sims' grieving father Don Ellison, Austin Rehearsal Complex (ARC) co-owners Don Harvey and Wayne Nagel, recording artist Alejandro Escovedo and attorney Walter Taylor. The original mission of SIMS was to connect musicians with therapists.

Peyton Wimmer was brought on as the foundation's first Executive Director one year after the creation of SIMS and, together with the founders, they galvanized Austin's close-knit music community to create a unique organization offering mental health services to local musicians.



Our Mission

The SIMS Foundation provides mental health and substance use recovery services and supports for musicians, music industry professionals, and their dependent family members. Through education, community partnerships, and accessible managed care, SIMS seeks to destigmatize and reduce mental health and substance use issues, while supporting and enhancing the wellbeing of the music community at large.



Our Process

The SIMS Foundation strives to make the process for all current and prospective clients a simple one. In order for an individual to engage in services, all they need to do is complete two forms that are found on The SIMS Foundation website (www.simsfoundation.org) and provide their proof of eligibility for SIMS services. Proof of eligibility is something that shows that the individual earned some portion of their income in the music industry in the last 12 months.

Upon receiving those forms, the prospective client is contacted to schedule an appointment for a clinical assessment with one of the clinical staff. This assessment helps the staff clinician understand what the client is struggling with and what led to their seeking care. It is also during this time that the clinical staff member provides psychoeducation about all the levels of care that are appropriate for the client and the reasons why one may be more appropriate than another.

Once the client chooses their path, the clinical staff member creates an authorization for the provider that is most appropriate for this client.



Our Services

Counseling Services

- Band Counseling
- Couples Counseling
- Family Counseling
- Group Counseling
- Individual Counseling
- Trauma Specific Counseling
- Partial Hospitalization Programs
- Intensive Outpatient Programs
- Free grief counseling when there is a loss in the music community

Psychiatric Services

- Psychiatric Assessment and Evaluation
- Medication Management
- Acute Psychiatric Hospitalization



Our Services (Continued)

Substance Use Disorder Services and Supports

- Medical Detoxification
- Residential Treatment
- Partial Hospitalization Programs
- Intensive Outpatient Programs
- Harm Reduction Counseling
- Medication Assisted Treatment
- Peer Recovery Coaching
- Recovery Residences



SIMS Music Community Trainings

In the summer of 2018, SIMS' clinical staff interviewed the staff members of several music venues with the goal of building a closer relationship with venues and to learn about their struggles in their roles in the industry.

This information was used to create a core curriculum of training for these staff members.

The core curriculum includes:

- Mental Health 101
- Substance Use Recovery 101 with Naloxone Training (facilitated with Peer Recovery Coaches from Communities for Recovery)
- SAFE Bar (Presented by the Sexual Assault Response and Resource Team through the Travis County Sheriff's)
- Currently working on a Trauma 101 module



How is SIMS Different?

SIMS is the only non-profit in the country providing comprehensive behavioral healthcare to musicians, music industry professionals and their dependent family members.

SIMS is “person-centered” in their approach with clients. This means that clients are provided with a thorough explanation of all the levels of care available to them based on their particular set of issues and then SIMS supports the client in their decision.

SIMS recognizes that recovery from mental health and substance use issues is as different as the individuals in recovery. There is no one RIGHT path.



How is SIMS Different? (Continued)

SIMS Clinical Staff provides intensive case management for all of our clients. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Psychoeducation for clients and their loved ones (band members, management, family members, friends, etc.).
- Supportive counseling for loved ones of clients who are either in crisis or have entered into a treatment facility.
- Communication with probation/parole officers, judges, attorneys and others in the justice system when a client is justice involved.
- Meeting weekly with the treatment team working with a client in a treatment facility.
- Ensuring coordination of care when clients are involved in more than one level of care or service.
- Assisting clients with accessing other services in the community to help them address other issues such as housing, employment, physical healthcare.

Partnerships

SIMS seeks partnerships with other organizations who work to support, improve, and transform the music industry. In addition, SIMS partners with other organizations offering services that help to improve the communities in which they operate. This is done through joint grant writing, programming, and event support.

- The Amplified Sound Coalition - (<https://www.theamplifiedsoundcoalition.org/>) – SIMS is partnered with TASC in advocacy work focused on the survival, sustainability and safety of the performance venue community.
- Be an #Arts Hero (<https://beanartshero.com/>) – SIMS has partnered with this organization in their advocacy at a Federal Government level for support for the arts.
- D Wood Foundation (<https://www.dwoodfoundation.org/>) – SIMS has been a partner of this organization for well over a year. The two organizations have worked on educational campaigns regarding behavioral health, joint grant writing and event support. Both organizations are focused on outreach and education for marginalized communities and on breaking down the stigma attached to behavioral health issues.

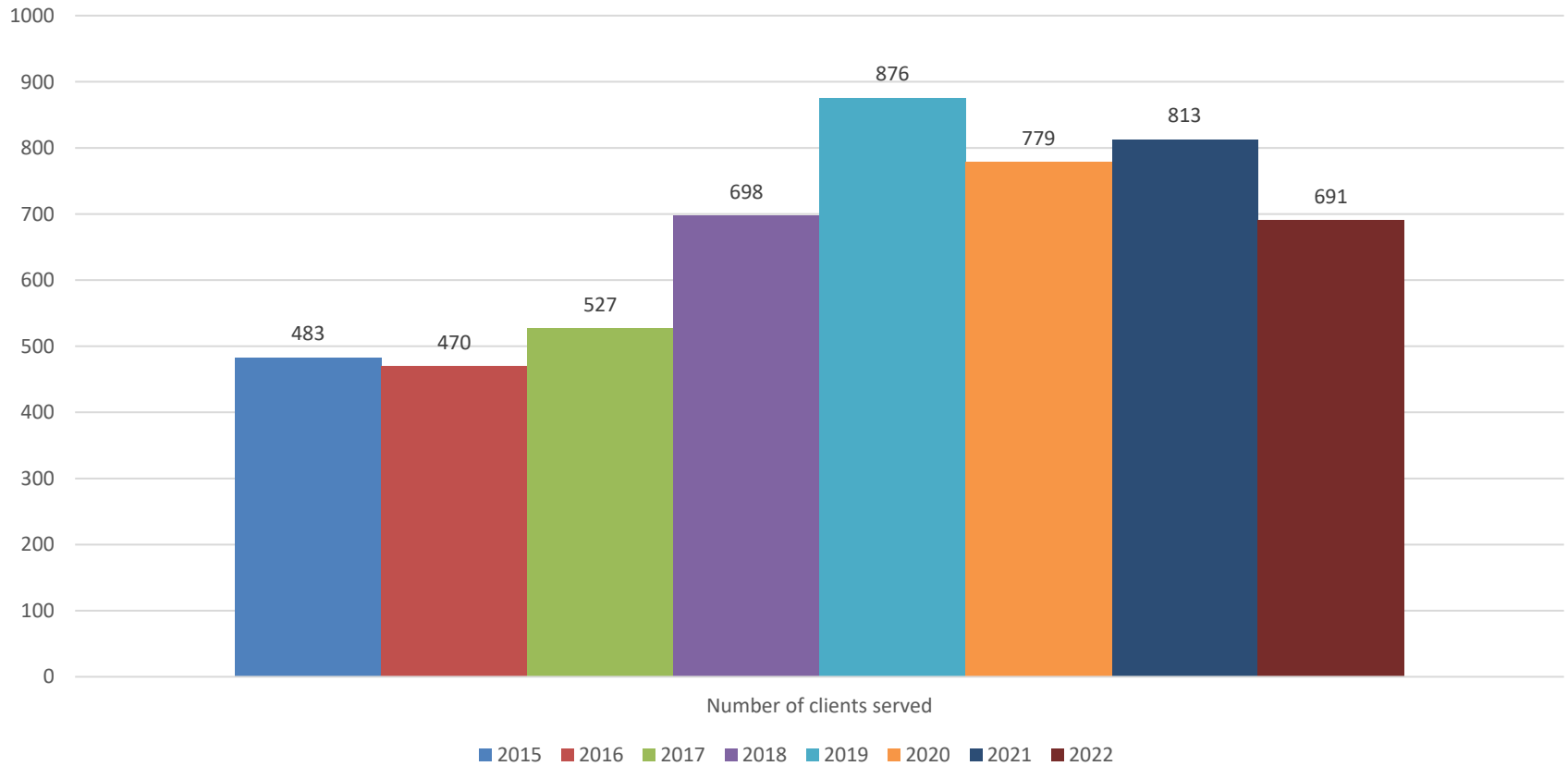
Partnerships (continued)

- The Roadie Clinic (<https://www.theroadieclinic.com/>) – SIMS began a partnership with the Roadie Clinic in the Summer of 2020. SIMS offers support, resources and information to clients of the Roadie Clinic dealing with mental health and/or substance use issues.
- Sexual Assault Response and Resource Team – SIMS partnered with this organization to bring SAFE Bar training to music venues in Central Texas.
- Texas Music Office – SIMS is the official non-profit partner of the Texas Music Office for their Music Friendly Communities. It is our hope that SIMS will expand to many of those same communities.
- Touring Professionals Alliance (<https://www.touringprofessionals.com/>) – SIMS serves as an advisor, resource, partner in the TPA's goal of improving touring with a focus on the wellbeing of the touring professionals.
- Travis County D.A.s Office – partnered on their initiative to reduce overdose deaths in our community.



SIMS Impact Statistics

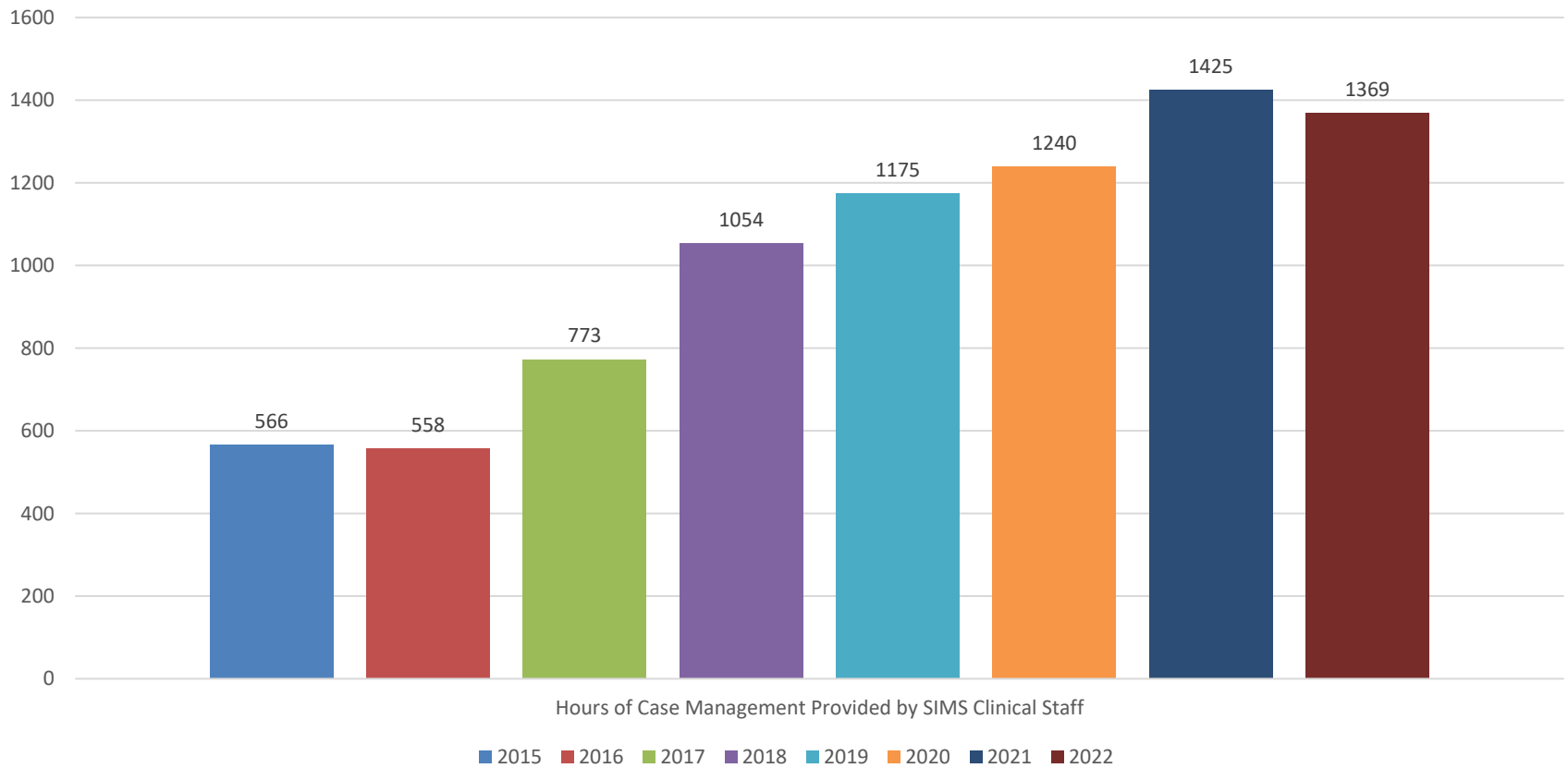
SIMS Impact





SIMS Impact Statistics

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